

No. 744, October 2011

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington



Robert's Ridge
Image courtesy of Hinrich Schaefer

Next section night: 3 October, 2011

Managing volcanic risk on Mt Ruapehu, by Harry Keys

Volcanic activity poses relatively high risks to recreational users on Ruapehu and historically significant risks to travel networks around it. Eruptions occur at irregular intervals, and many are unpredictable. The risks are very low on an individual visit basis. But lahars threaten people in the Summit Hazard Zone and lahars threaten hundreds of people on ski areas. A breakout of the lake in 1953 led to the deaths of 151 people in the Tangawai Disaster.

The threat of a similar event after the 1995-96 eruption spurred environmental and risk assessments, extensive consultation and intensive scrutiny. The outcome on 18 March 2007 when the predicted breakout occurred showed that resilience of communities to recurring lahar threats was achieved by adopting long-term solutions rather than short-term ones.

Lessons are now being applied to improving management of eruption and lahar risk. Reviews of warning systems and risk management drove a major upgrade of the lahar early warning system on the mountain. The GeoNet system and other agency synergies, volcano and system monitoring and agency readiness are much improved. But there is still a significant residual risk to people in lahar paths. Like in climbing, individual attitudes towards the risks and personal responsibility are important.



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.

Update from the USA

Kevin Patterson

Spiderwoman on Spiderman!

Smiths Rock – Bend, Oregon

Almost all of you will be wondering 'where is this place called Smiths Rock?'. As was I until someone mentioned it as a place worth visiting for rock climbing on our way north to escape the heat of California. What I ended up seeing was a place which towered up to 150m high, had a base circumference of 4km, and 1800 mainly sport routes, many multipitch, on quality volcanic 'tuff'. Only the Arapiles would be comparable in scale for Australasia.

Smith Rock is located in central Oregon about 1000km north of Yosemite. It has its own climbers campground similar in style to the Arapiles, but with showers!! And costs just US\$5/person/day with no restrictions on length of stay. Compared to Camp 4 at Yosemite, where a 7 day max now applies, this is true freedom. And we met several who had been here for significant periods up to several months.

Gradings here are based on the American system. And like the Arapiles, due to the period of the establishment of most routes in the early days, there is some huge inconsistencies in the grading at the lower end so there is a significant danger in being sandbagged.

We spent 3 days climbing fairly straightforward routes (5.5 to 5.8, or about 14-18 on the NZ/OZ scale when adjusted for sandbagging) knocking off classics on Cinnamon Slabs, Spiderman Butte (Spiderman, a 2 pitch 5.7), and the Red Cliffs. Super Slab (5.6) a 3 pitch 100m classic on the Red Cliffs took us 3h to climb...then a further 90m to find a way to eventually rap off!

Heat can be extreme in August here, most days it gets to 30-35C in the shade so it pays to start early, i.e. be up by 6am :o. And take lots of water. And then follow the shade around during the day. At least that way someone told us, "you'll be ahead of the 20 somethings who won't be out of bed before 8am"

Hardest route I climbed was Phasmagorgia, a 5.10c (about a 20), 25m crimp climb on Red Cliff. Most of the climbs were quite crimpy, as opposed to the granite hand jams needed at Yosemite and around Tahoe.

The renowned test piece here is the Monkey Face, a 120m high pillar with a couple of caves near the top – it really does look like a monkey! You can do it as a 4 pitch 5.8 with a 30m bolted aid section. My recommendation if you make it this far.

Climbers: Kevin Patterson and Christine Latimer



Robert's Ridge backcountry ski trip (Aug 19-21) on a scale from 1-10

Weather: 10/10

Company: 10/10

Sunset flight into Blenheim: 9/10

Picking up stove fuel at a helpful hardware store employees house after hours: 11/10

Frosty night on DoC campground: 6/10

DoC worker opening Robert's Road for us saving 1 hr walk: 9/10

26 switchbacks on Pinchgut Trail: 3/10

Ski trip after a week of snowstorms (in Wellington!): 10/10

No fresh snow from these storms on Robert's Ridge: 2/10

Skier splitting off due to different pace: 3/10

Carrying skis on packs for 80% of first day (to snowline, in technical terrain): 3/10

Alpenglow in the Nelson Lakes: 10/10

Only ski run of the day: 4/10

Reaching Angelus Hut in the last fading light: 8/10

Dehy beef curry for dinner: 2/10

Dehy beef curry when you are really hungry: 3/10

Carrying unpalatable beef curry out the next day: 1/10

Finding "lost" favourite shirt between pack and packliner: 9/10

Having to tell everybody you asked if they've seen it: 3/10

Reversing steps in the morning sun: 8/10

Actually getting first turns down the ridge: 10/10

Yoyo skiing at the old club field: 11/10

Sweet turns in spring corn down to snowline: 12/10

Reuniting with lone member of party: 10/10

Having to speed to catch flights in Nelson: 1/10

Fortuitously doing the limit when meeting the one police car: 8/10

Birdseye view of the Marlborough sounds during return flight: 9/10

Overall Rating: ***** Brilliant!

On the trip: Rebecca Thompson, Lara Wilcock, Julie Deslippe, Scott Taylor, Simon Romanos, Drew McGlashen, Hinrich Schaefer



2011 NZAC Photo Competition Results – Award Winners

Harrison Memorial Trophy and Eric Beuzenberg Memorial Award – Andrew Peacock for Arctic Aerial Abstract

Guide Alack Challenge Cup – Kevin Boekholt for Tree Skiing in British Columbia

Alpine Recreation Youth Award – 6-day basic instruction course – Joshua Taylor for A Taranaki Sunrise

Egmont Tasman Trophy – Canterbury / Westland Section

To view images and a full list of winners:
<https://alpineclub.org.nz/photocomp>

The 2012 NZAC calendar featuring images from this year's competition will be available to purchase in a few weeks.

Backorders can be placed via our online shopping here: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nzac-alpine-calendar-2012>

Members \$15 and non-members \$20 including p&p



Arctic Aerial Abstract
by Andrew Peacock

Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

October 22–24 (Labour weekend): Mt. Tapuae-o-Uenuku

Trip organiser: Wiebke Heise

Difficulty: 2-

Experience: AIC or above

Any clear day the highest mountain outside the Southern Alps beckons to Wellington climbers. Have you ever thought about standing up there and looking back? Join our trip this Labour Day weekend, follow the classic route up the Hodder River into the heart of the Inland Kaikouras. While “Tappi” is not a technical route more difficult objectives are close by (Mt. Alarm) for eager participants.

Contact Wiebke by email at w.heise@gns.cri.nz

November 18–20: Castle Hill

Trip organiser: TBA

Nobody who is serious about rock needs an intro to bouldering and climbing at Castle Hill. We'll head over to the South Island and and pull, crimp, balance, dyno, smear and hook as long and as hard as you want.

December 3–11: Mt Tasman

Trip Leader – Rob Hawes

Yes this will be a rewarding and challenging Climb of NZ's 2nd highest peak, for views up and down the main divide, incl. Mt Cook summit, west out over the Tasman Sea and East to Mackenzie Basin and beyond. We depart after work on the Friday and fly to Pioneer Hut on the Saturday. (back up will be Porters Lodge if weather prevents us from getting in). After smaller warm up climbs clearly the main objective is Mt Tasman. This will be a long day (15+ hrs) to climb the traditional route; a high level of fitness is a must. The route takes us across the glacier up to Marcel Col, over Mt Lendenfeld (a 10,000 ft peak!), and up the North Shoulder to the summit ridge, usually a knife edge at the last. Lots of pitching and protecting the knife edge ridge require good climbing skills.

All intending participants on this trip will need to provide experience details and the organizer needs to reserve the right to limit who participates in this trip for safety reasons.

Contact Rob Hawes Wk: 04 474-1277; Cell 0274 470 461 or by email to roberth@tfg.co.nz

For general info: Hinrich at 04 386 0316 or by hs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Wellington Section library – be where the action is



The Wellington Section is in need of a new librarian. It's a simple enough role that puts you in the heart of the action:

- Manage the Section's exciting library of books, DVDs, and VHS video cassettes
- Take charge of the library's budget, and buy whatever takes your fancy. New books! New movies! The choice is yours.
- Opportunities abound to meet fellow librarians (pictured left).
- Applications are now being accepted – please email James Wright at chairperson@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for further details.

The Wellington Section library is also missing a number of items which may be sitting forgotten on members' shelves – please scan the list below, and if anything sounds familiar it would be appreciated if you could check that it isn't on yours...

Overdue

508	The Rock Warriors's Way	Ilgner, Arno	Book
504	Training For Climbing	Horst, Eric J	Book
502	Cliffhanger		DVD
500	Traditional Lead Climbing	Pesterfield, Heidi	Book
498	This Game of Ghosts	Joe Simpson	Book
494	Revelations	Jerry Moffat	Book
493	Between a Rock and a Hard Place	Aron Ralston	Book
491	High Misadventure	Paul Hersey	Book
486	Masters of Stone VI	Eric Perlman	DVD
479	Into Thin Air		DVD
475	Rock Climbing Anchors: A Comprehensive Guide	Craig Luebben	Book
466	Arapiles, Selected Climbs	Simon Mentz	Book
460	Rock Climbing - Getting Started	Glenn Tempest	Book
458	Kiss or Kill	Mark Twight	Book
442	K2 - A Challenge to the Sky	Roberto Mantonvani	Book
440	First Ascent	Peter Mortimer	DVD
426	Wellington Rock	Kristen Foley	Guide
387	Southern Faces		DVD
388	New Zealand Backcountry Skiing	James Broadbent	Guide
377	Barron Saddle - Mount Brewster	Ross Cullen	Guide

Missing in Action

481	The Illustrated Guide to Glacier Travel Rescue	Andy Tyson / Mike Clelland	Book
463	Dingle - Discovering the sense of adventure	Graeme Dingle	Book
443	The Boys of Everest	Clint Willis	Book
433	The Darran Mountains	Craig Jeffries	Guide
424	Alpine Skills 34 - Mountain Safety Council	Cathye Haddocjk	Instructional
384	Arthur's Pass - A Guide to Mountaineers	Graeme Kates	Guide
371	High Adventure	Edmund Hillary	Book
370	Avalanche Accidents in Aotearoa	Dave Irwin/Will Macqueen	Book
366	Above the Clouds	Anatoli Boukreev	Book
300	Aoraki Mount Cook, A Guide to Mountaineers	Alex Palman	Guide
299	The Mount Aspiring Region - A Guide for Mountaineers	Allen Uren / Mark Watson	Guide

Notices

NZAC notices

Registration for Climbing Camp 2012 now open

This summer Climbing Camp will be held at Aoraki Mt Cook, courtesy of the South Canterbury section. The base will be the new improved Unwin Lodge, and participants will be able to book a bunk, or camp and use the hut facilities.

For information and a registration form, go to: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/event/annual-climbing-camp>

Unwin Lodge official opening

Dear NZAC members

This is your email invite to the Unwin Lodge Official Opening on Sunday 16 Oct, from 10am at Unwin. Be part of the celebration of the largest project NZAC has completed in recent history! Morning tea and a tour of the new facilities will be provided as part of the programme at the Opening. If you plan to attend, please RSVP to unwin@alpineclub.org.nz.

NZAC survey

We are currently conducting a short survey of all our members to learn more about what you want from your Club. This will help us with our future planning and budgeting of Club activities and events, and as a result deliver more great stuff to our members!

The survey is only a few pages and should only take five minutes to complete and return via this online survey form: <http://www.surveymonkey.com/s/NZACsurvey2011>

Just to add a little incentive to the deal, return this survey by Friday 30 September and you'll go in the draw to win \$250 of NZAC goodies (your choice of guidebooks, hut nights, event tickets, or membership). This survey will close on Friday October 7th, 2011.

Instruction courses for this summer almost full

The Mountain Skills for Women and Advanced High Alpine Skills courses are now full.

There are still limited spaces left on the High Alpines Skills Courses (three alternative dates) and on the Intro to Multi Pitch Alpine Rock Climbing Course.

For more information on the courses go to: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine>

Accommodation at Unwin will be available from Sunday night (16 October): \$15 members, \$30 non-members (note new rates). To book a bunk for Sunday night and onwards, please email unwin@alpineclub.org.nz (first in, first served J).

Cheers,

Ollie Clifton Executive Officer
New Zealand Alpine Club

Participation in the survey is completely voluntary and all responses will be kept strictly confidential. The final results will be made available on the Club website from early November, and be reported in the summer issue of The Climber magazine in a few months time. Returned surveys will be destroyed once the survey is complete.

Don't hesitate to contact me directly with any questions you have regarding this survey.

Cheers,

Ollie Clifton Executive Officer
New Zealand Alpine Club

NZAC notices cont.

Travel Insurance

Our broker and ACE Insurance have agreed to provide Club members with an extended travel cover offer. We now have new cheaper rates for trips from 120-365 days duration. The new rates are available for either general travel, or travel involving hazardous pursuits and are charged at a flat rate so there is no need to specify the number of days you need high-risk cover for on longer trips. We have been very lucky to have ACE agree to extend and now expand, NZAC's cover for another year and hope that members will continue to enjoy the benefits of this policy offer. For details please see the NZAC website, or contact narina@alpineclub.org.nz

New Guidebook – Sublime Climbs

A guide to the best rock climbing venues in Victoria, Australia. The bulk of this guidebook is devoted to route descriptions, photo-topos and action photos of a selection of wonderful routes from the three premier climbing areas in the state.

Purchase online here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/sublime-climbs>

New DVD – Beyond the Plains

Beyond The Plains is a showcase of four areas within the Canterbury region, all with vastly different styles and atmosphere, yet with their own qualities that made them special places to visit.

Purchase online here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/beyond-the-plains-dvd>

Powell Hut Bookable – November through February

It is no secret that the Powell-Jumbo circuit in the Tararua Forest Park is very popular with trampers; both novice and experienced alike. With the influx of trampers over the summer season we would like to initiate a change to better serve the needs of our visitors. The Wairarapa Area is making that possible by making Powell hut bookable from 1 November 2011 to 28 February 2012.

All parties are expected to book if they require accommodation at Powell hut from November through February. The hut fees will not change [\$15 for adults (18+) and \$5 for youth (11-17)]. An additional \$5 to \$10 management fee will apply depending on party size. Transfers and

cancellations are subject to conditions. The only charge backcountry hut pass holders incur is the management fee for their party.

The hut can be booked over the phone through the Wairarapa DOC office (06) 377 0700 or in person at 220 South Road, Masterton. The Department of Conservation is continually working to ensure safe backcountry environments and positive tramping experiences.

As a friendly reminder, there are no dogs allowed in backcountry huts. All hunters must comply with the Arms Code. Any disorderly conduct will not be tolerated and will be handled in conjunction with the local police.

Transceivers for sale

Barryvox Opto 3000 Transceivers for sale. \$250. Five years old. Good condition. Excellent unit for beginners and seasoned searchers. Full digital or analog and multi burial function.

Contact Tarn
03 4412722
elcapitarn@xtra.co.nz
0276444432

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	vacant		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	vacant	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz

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If undelivered please return to:

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